Teacher Wu Kuan | See It at a Glance #4 — Slope = Rise ÷ Run

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1. The trap question

What is the slope of a line?

2. The method

• Slope = rise / run = $(y_2 - y_1) / (x_2 - x_1)$.
• Up as you go right → positive; down → negative; flat → 0.

3. Parent check method

Have your child draw the little right triangle between two points and count rise and run.

Practice

1. Slope through (1, 2) and (3, 8)
2. Slope through (0, 5) and (4, 1)
3. Slope through (−2, 1) and (2, 3)
4. Slope of a horizontal line
5. A line with slope 2 passes through (1, 3). Find its y-intercept.

Answers

1. 3
2. −1
3. 1/2
4. 0
5. 1 (y = 2x + 1)

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